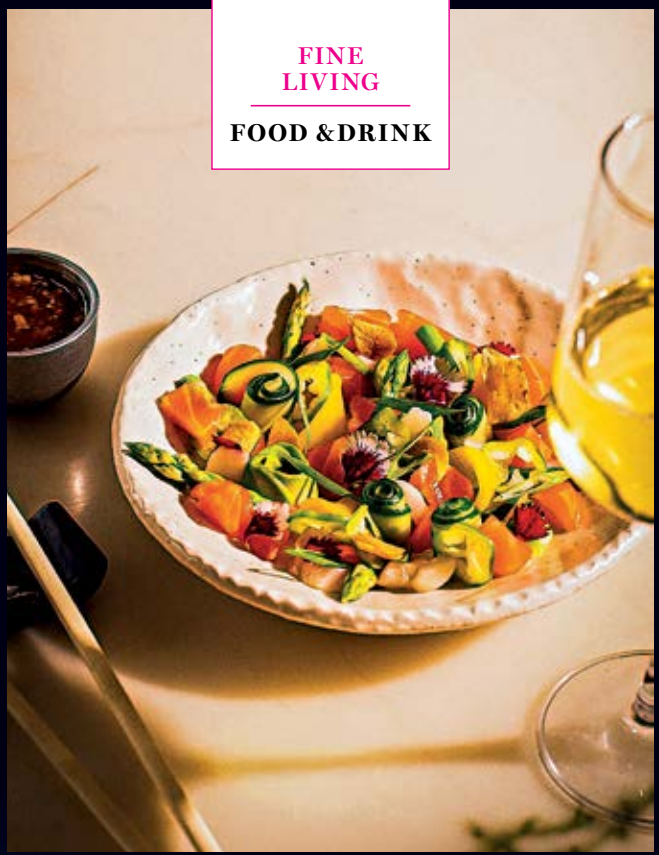
HIGH FIVE

Chumki Bharadwaj



KLAP

With malleable attention reduced to about 30 seconds on the Gram and brand loyalty about as dependable as the IMD forecast for rain, a restaurant celebrating five years is as much anomaly as achievement today. More so, in the tony environs of Delhi's Khan Market, where the discerning come out to sample the delectable and just as quickly, deport the less desirable. So as KLAP completes its half decade validation, it's time to applaud. Fittingly, the restaurant has introduced a new food and cocktail programme as an homage to the evolution of its host venue; the new menu meanders between the market's five distinct lanes, tracing its beginnings as a travellers' market in 1951, the bookseller years, its diplomatic influence; emergence as a dining destination, and of course, present-day avatar as an after hours melting pot.

While storytelling has its exalted place on the marketing pyramid, is the new worth attendance and attention? Yes, especially when it comes to cocktails. As Navdeep Singh Sethi, Co-Founder, KLAP, puts it: "Guests may not remember every ingredient in a drink, but they always remember how easily they returned to it and the kind of evening it became part of." A boast that is definitely not in vain: On the new liquid menu, the Spice Route, which is a zingy liquid with Pisco, carrot, lapsang and bird's eye chillis is a crowd pleaser, the real surprise is II Chapter, a nutty, layered, delight with tequila, mezcal, soy and hazelnut—a marriage that may not seem obvious but is worth several refills.

The food, closely tied to appetite and familiarity, ranges from modern Indian to Asian, Japanese, and European. While the KLAP Bhel with avocado, glazed pumpkin, and crisp brown rice offers dollops of flavour and freshness, the salmon ceviche, which is supposed to summon citrus and sharp heat, is tepid on the flavour scale. The tiny ghee podi idli coins punch above their weight, as do the coastal prawns. As for desserts, the Gelato Egg Tray with its layered chocolate shell and flavoured gelato is genius—sates the sweet spot without the calorie or conscience overload.

Price ₹5,000 (Meal for two without alcohol)





Chosen, Not Bought

Aarambh